

```
142cc07007d0107e8ff91b28e2a7b078a6f56d1c tree
3af6fea8dbb44973ddeed856036d0792d15a4ad7 commit
81bc58de5525b0c16f8cb74b89799017b6986981 blob
```

Finally, use *fsck* to check for the dangling commits. You will find that all of them have been cleared:

```
% git fsck --lost-found
```

```
Checking object directories: 100% (256/256), done.
Checking objects: 100% (66417/66417), done.
```

Alternate choices

Another way to clean up orphaned branches is by using the *prune* option but with the commands *git fetch* and *git remove*. Orphaned branches are not connected to other branches and have been left unused. It is a good practice to prune the branches that are not being used. The simplest way to do this is by using the command *git fetch --prune*. This will fetch all the remote branch *refs*, and delete the remote *refs* that are no longer in use in the remote repository. It's advisable to use the dry run before execution, such as:

```
git fetch --prune origin --dry-run
```

Next, let's look at *git remote prune*. Just like *git fetch --prune*, this command will also remove the *refs* to the branches that don't exist on the remote data. We can use *git remote prune* when we want to prune but not fetch the remote data. The git maintains both the local/origin and remote/origin refs. This command will only prune the refs from the remote/origin and leave the local/origin refs untouched. We can use just *git prune* to delete only the locally detached commits, as seen in the above example.

Now that you have seen the usage and different options of git prune, try and use it to keep your git clean. Happy housekeeping! 

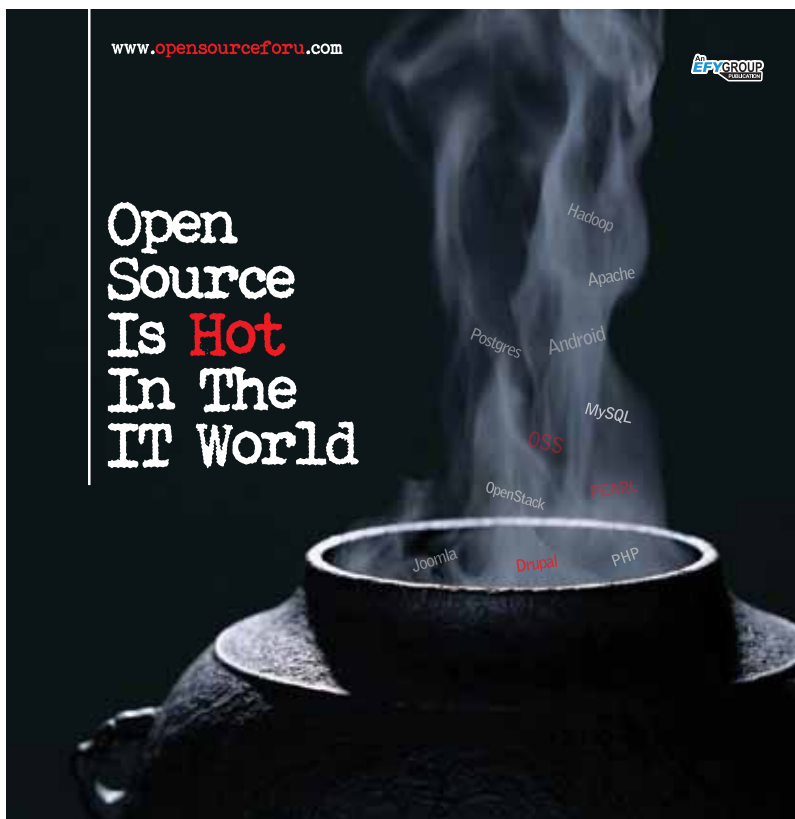
Reference

<https://www.atlassian.com/git/tutorials/git-prune>

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The author is employed in a leading bank as an AVP. She is a perennial learner who loves the quote:

"The more I learn, the more I realise how much I don't know."
—Albert Einstein



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